How to read a unit: from right to left

1. Find the **symbol of the unit**: it is the **last** letter (or letters).
2. Say which **quantity** it measures: m → length, g → mass, L → capacity, s → time…
3. Look at the letter **in front**: it is the **prefix**. Multiple or submultiple?

km

m = metre
→ **length**

k = kilo = 10^3

MULTIPLE

mg

g = gram
→ **mass**

m = milli = 10^{-3}

SUBMULTIPLE

cL

L = litre
→ **capacity**

c = centi = 10^{-2}

SUBMULTIPLE

mm

m (2nd) = metre
→ **length**

m (1st) = milli = 10^{-3}

SUBMULTIPLE

hPa

Pa = pascal
→ **pressure**

h = hecto = 10^2

MULTIPLE

If there is **no letter** in front of the unit (m, g, L, s…), it is the **base unit**. Careful with **mm**: the first m is the prefix and the second m is the unit!